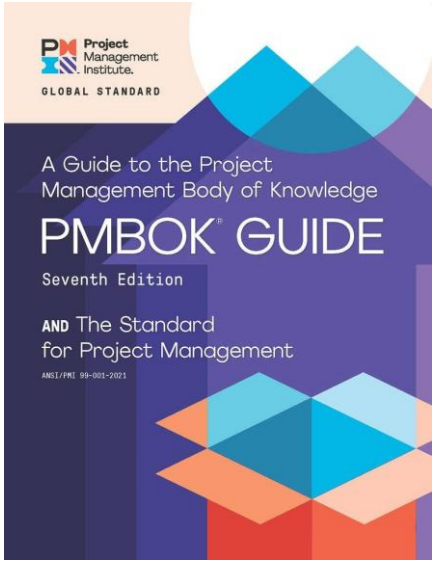
IT3120- Lecture 9

Project Management – Stakeholder & Communication Management

Activities, Tools, Techniques, Inputs and Outputs related to Stakeholder Management and Communication Management



Lecture Objectives

- Explain stakeholder management and communication management concepts.
- Identify stakeholders and analyze their influence.
- Describe key processes, inputs, tools, techniques, and outputs (ITTOs).
- Develop stakeholder engagement strategies.
- Design effective communication plans.

What is Stakeholder Management?

- Stakeholder management is the systematic approach of identifying, analyzing, and engaging individuals, groups, or organizations that can affect or are affected by a project.



- It focuses on understanding stakeholders' needs, expectations, interests, and level of influence, and then developing appropriate strategies to effectively involve them throughout the project lifecycle.

Key Processes in Stakeholder Management

- Stakeholders are properly identified, understood, and engaged throughout the project lifecycle. These processes are not strictly linear, and they often overlap and are revisited as the project evolves.
- Key stakeholder management processes include:


Identify Stakeholders


Plan Stakeholder Engagement


Manage Stakeholder Engagement


Monitor Stakeholder Engagement

Key Processes in Stakeholder Management



Identify Stakeholders

This is the foundational process where all individuals, groups, or organizations that may impact or be impacted by the project are identified.

What happens in this process:

- Recognizing both **internal stakeholders** (project team, management) and **external stakeholders** (clients, vendors, regulators).
- Understanding their **roles, interests, expectations, and influence.**
- Documenting relevant details such as communication needs and engagement preferences.



Identify Stakeholders (Contd.)

Key techniques:

- Brainstorming sessions with the project team
- Interviews with sponsors or domain experts
- Stakeholder mapping (e.g., power-interest grid)

Main output:

- **Stakeholder Register**, which typically includes:
  - Name and role
  - Influence and interest level
  - Expectations and concerns
  - Communication preferences
- **Why it matters:**

  Missing a key stakeholder early can lead to major risks, resistance, or project delays later.

Key Processes in Stakeholder Management



Plan Stakeholder Engagement

This process focuses on developing strategies to effectively engage stakeholders based on their needs and level of influence.

What happens in this process:

- Analyzing stakeholder expectations and attitudes (supportive, neutral, resistant).
- Defining tailored engagement approaches for different stakeholder groups.
- Determining how often and in what manner stakeholders should be involved.



Plan Stakeholders Engagement (Contd.)

Key techniques:

- Stakeholder analysis (power vs. interest, influence vs. impact)
- Prioritization methods
- Expert judgment and team discussions

Main output:

- **Stakeholder Engagement Plan**, which includes:
  - Engagement strategies for each stakeholder/group
  - Communication approaches
  - Methods for managing expectations and resolving conflicts

Why it matters:

A one-size-fits-all approach doesn’t work. Different stakeholders require different levels and styles of engagement.

Key Processes in Stakeholder Management



Manage Stakeholder Engagement

This is the execution phase where planned strategies are **put into action**.

What happens in this process:

- Communicating regularly with stakeholders.
- Addressing concerns, issues, and feedback.
- Managing expectations and building relationships.
- Resolving conflicts and negotiating when necessary.



Manage Stakeholder Engagement (Contd.)

Key techniques:

- Effective communication (meetings, reports, informal discussions)
- Interpersonal and leadership skills
- Conflict resolution and negotiation

Typical outputs:

- Change requests (if stakeholder needs lead to scope or plan changes)
- Updates to project documents
- Issue logs and feedback records

Why it matters:

This process directly impacts stakeholder satisfaction and support, which are critical for project success.

Key Processes in Stakeholder Management



Monitor Stakeholder Engagement

This process ensures that stakeholder engagement strategies remain effective over time.

What happens in this process:

- Tracking stakeholder attitudes and engagement levels.
- Evaluating whether current strategies are working.
- Identifying new stakeholders or changing stakeholder dynamics.
- Adjusting engagement approaches when needed.



Monitor Stakeholder Engagement (Contd.)

Key techniques:

- Feedback collection (surveys, meetings, informal check-ins)
- Performance reviews and analysis
- Issue tracking and trend analysis

Typical outputs:

- Work performance information
- Change requests (to improve engagement strategies)
- Updates to stakeholder engagement plan and register

Why it matters:

Stakeholder attitudes can change during a project. Continuous monitoring helps prevent issues before they escalate.

Stakeholder Analysis Models



Stakeholder management analysis models are techniques used to evaluate and categorize stakeholders based on factors such as their influence, interest, authority, attitude, and impact on the project.



These models help project managers understand stakeholder behavior and determine the most appropriate engagement and communication strategies.

Stakeholder analysis models support project teams in:

- Identifying key stakeholders who require close attention.
- Prioritizing stakeholder engagement efforts.
- Managing stakeholder expectations effectively.
- Reducing resistance and improving collaboration.



Common Stakeholder Analysis Models

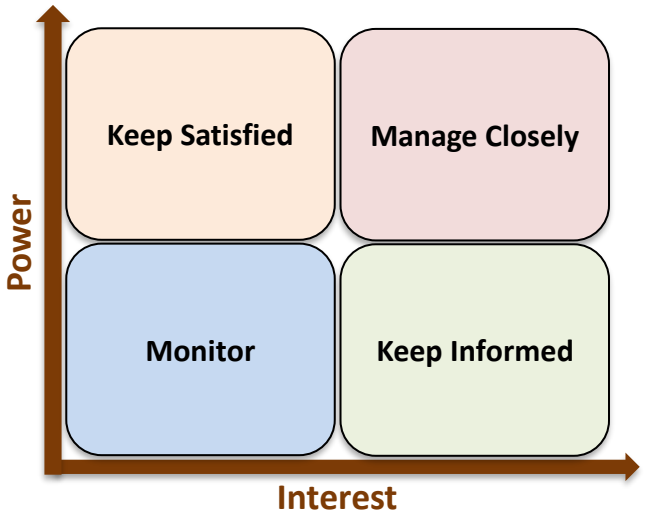
Stakeholder analysis models are frameworks used to classify and evaluate stakeholders based on their level of authority, interest, influence, impact, and involvement in a project. These models help project managers determine how stakeholders should be engaged, communicated with, and managed throughout the project lifecycle.



Common Stakeholder Analysis Models

1. Power–Interest Grid

- The **Power–Interest Grid** is one of the most widely used stakeholder analysis models.
- It classifies stakeholders according to:
  - **Power** → The stakeholder's ability to influence project decisions or outcomes
  - **Interest** → The level of concern or involvement the stakeholder has in the project



Categories in Power-Interest Grid

High Power – Low Interest → Keep Satisfied

These stakeholders can significantly impact the project but may not require detailed involvement.

Examples:

- Department heads
- Regulatory authorities

Management Approach:

- Provide summarized updates
- Avoid overloading with unnecessary details
- Ensure their expectations are met

High Power – High Interest → Manage Closely

These stakeholders have strong influence and are highly interested in project outcomes.

Examples:

- Project sponsor
- Major client

Management Approach:

- Frequent communication
- Involvement in major decisions
- Regular status meetings

Low Power – Low Interest → Monitor

These stakeholders require minimal effort but should still be observed.

Examples:

- General public
- Minor suppliers

Management Approach:

- Occasional communication
- Monitor for changes in interest or influence

Low Power – High Interest → Keep Informed

These stakeholders are interested in project progress but have limited authority.

Examples:

- End users
- Operational staff
- QA team members

Management Approach:

- Regular updates and demonstrations
- Encourage feedback and participation

Common Stakeholder Analysis Models

2. Power–Influence Grid

- This model classifies stakeholders based on:
  - **Power** → Formal authority or control
  - **Influence** → Ability to shape opinions, decisions, or project direction
- **Purpose**

  Used when some stakeholders may not have formal authority but can strongly influence others.
- **Example**

  In a software project:
  - A senior architect may have high influence even without managerial power.
  - A sponsor may have both high power and influence.
- **Benefits**
  - Helps identify informal leaders
  - Supports political and organizational awareness
  - Useful in large organizations

Common Stakeholder Analysis Models

3. Influence–Impact Grid

- This model evaluates stakeholders according to:
  - **Influence →** Ability to affect project activities
  - **Impact →** Degree to which the project affects the stakeholder
- **Purpose**

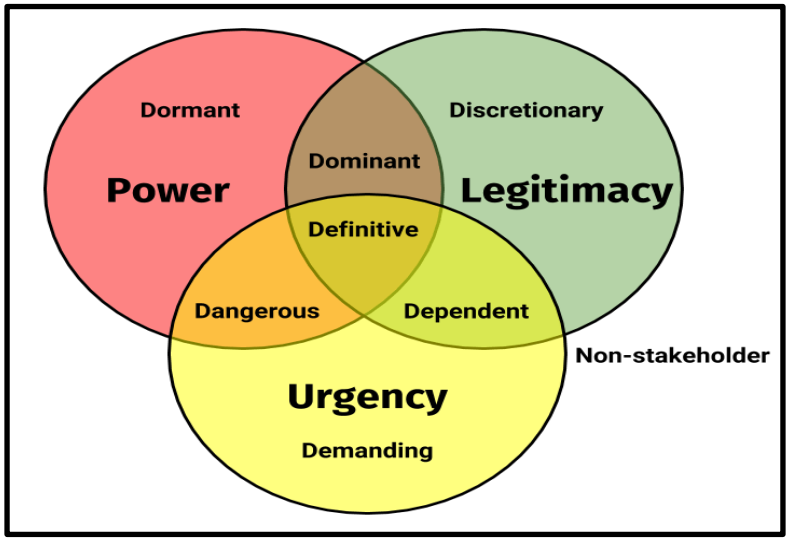
  Helps identify stakeholders who may be heavily affected by the project even if they lack authority.
- **Example**

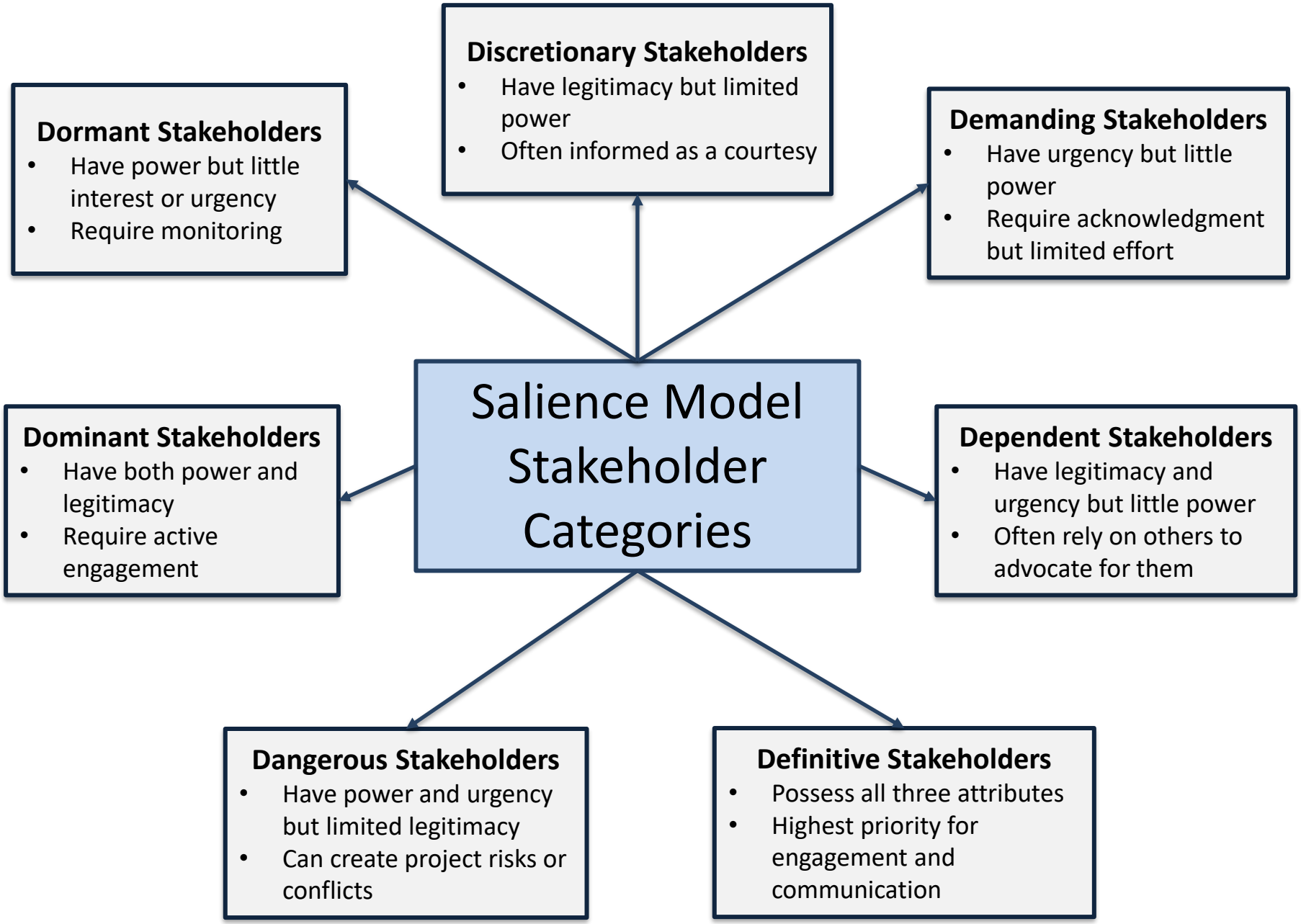
  A new enterprise system implementation:
  - Employees may have low influence but high impact because their daily work changes significantly.
- **Benefits**
  - Supports change management
  - Helps reduce user resistance
  - Improves adoption and acceptance

Common Stakeholder Analysis Models

3. Salience Model

- The **Salience Model** is a more advanced stakeholder analysis model that categorizes stakeholders using three attributes:
  - **Power** → Ability to influence the project
  - **Legitimacy** → Validity of the stakeholder's involvement
  - **Urgency** → Need for immediate attention




Salience Model Stakeholder Categories
Discretionary Stakeholders
• Have legitimacy but limited power
• Often informed as a courtesy
Dormant Stakeholders
• Have power but little interest or urgency
• Require monitoring
Demanding Stakeholders
• Have urgency but little power
• Require acknowledgment but limited effort
Dominant Stakeholders
• Have both power and legitimacy
• Require active engagement
Dependent Stakeholders
• Have legitimacy and urgency but little power
• Often rely on others to advocate for them
Dangerous Stakeholders
• Have power and urgency but limited legitimacy
• Can create project risks or conflicts
Definitive Stakeholders
• Possess all three attributes
• Highest priority for engagement and communication

Comparison of Stakeholder Analysis Models

Model	Main Focus	Best Used For
Power–Interest Grid	Authority and involvement	General stakeholder management
Power–Influence Grid	Authority and persuasion	Organizational politics
Influence–Impact Grid	Project effect on stakeholders	Change management
Salience Model	Priority based on 3 attributes	Complex stakeholder environments

Importance of Stakeholder Analysis Models

These models help project managers to:

- Prioritize stakeholder engagement
- Allocate communication efforts effectively
- Anticipate conflicts and resistance
- Improve decision-making
- Enhance project success rates

In IT and software projects, stakeholder analysis is especially important because projects often involve:

- Multiple departments
- Diverse user groups
- Frequent requirement changes
- High dependency on communication and collaboration

Practical Example in an IT Project

- **Project:** Development of a University Learning Management System (LMS).

Stakeholder	Analysis
University Management	High Power – High Interest
Lecturers	High Interest – Medium Influence
Students	High Impact – Low Power
IT Department	High Influence
Software Vendor	High Interest and Influence

- Using stakeholder analysis models helps the project manager decide:
  - Who needs weekly meetings
  - Who should receive detailed reports
  - Who should be consulted before major decisions
  - Who only requires periodic updates

Stakeholder Engagement Levels



Stakeholder engagement levels represent the degree of support, participation, and involvement stakeholders have toward a project.



Understanding these levels helps project managers assess stakeholder attitudes and develop appropriate strategies to improve collaboration and project success.



Stakeholders may move between engagement levels throughout the project lifecycle, so continuous monitoring and communication are important.

Common stakeholder engagement levels include:

1. **Unaware**

   Stakeholders are not aware of the project or its potential impact. They have little or no knowledge about project objectives, activities, or outcomes.

2. **Resistant**

   Stakeholders are aware of the project but oppose it or show negative attitudes toward project changes or decisions. They may create obstacles or resistance.

3. **Neutral**

   Stakeholders are aware of the project but neither support nor resist it. They may show limited involvement or interest.

4. **Supportive**

   Stakeholders understand the benefits of the project and actively support project goals and activities.

5. **Leading**

   Stakeholders are highly engaged and actively promote the project. They contribute to decision-making, encourage others, and help drive project success.

Project managers aim to move stakeholders toward supportive or leading engagement levels through effective communication, involvement, relationship building, and stakeholder management strategies.



In Class Activity 1

Multiple Choice Question

Which stakeholder analysis model classifies stakeholders based on their level of power and interest?

A. Communication Model
B. Power–Interest Grid
C. Fishbone Diagram
D. Work Breakdown Structure



Multiple Choice Question

Which stakeholder engagement level represents stakeholders who actively support and promote the project?

A. Resistant
B. Neutral
C. Leading
D. Unaware



Short Answer Question

Briefly explain why stakeholder management is important in IT projects.



What is Communication Management?

- Communication management is the process of planning, creating, distributing, monitoring, and managing project information to ensure that the right information reaches the right stakeholders at the right time.



- It focuses on establishing effective communication among project team members, stakeholders, sponsors, clients, and other involved parties to support collaboration, decision-making, and project success.

Communication management involves:

- Identifying stakeholder communication needs.
- Determining what information should be communicated.
- Selecting appropriate communication methods and channels.
- Managing the flow of project information.
- Monitoring the effectiveness of communication activities.



Effective communication management helps to:

- Reduce misunderstandings and conflicts
- Improve coordination among teams
- Support timely decision-making
- Enhance stakeholder engagement and satisfaction
- Ensure transparency throughout the project lifecycle

Communication management is considered a continuous process that must adapt to project changes, stakeholder expectations, organizational culture, and communication technologies.

Key Processes in Communication Management

- The key processes in communication management focus on ensuring that project information is properly planned, shared, monitored, and managed throughout the project lifecycle.
- These processes help maintain effective communication among stakeholders, project teams, sponsors, and other involved parties.
- The main communication management processes include:


Plan Communication Management


Manage Communications


Monitor Communications

- These communication management processes are interconnected and continuous, helping project teams maintain clear, accurate, and effective communication throughout the project lifecycle.



Plan Communication Management

This process involves determining the communication needs of stakeholders and defining how project information will be created, distributed, stored, and managed.

Main activities:

- Identifying stakeholder communication requirements
- Determining communication methods and channels
- Defining communication frequency and responsibilities
- Establishing reporting formats and procedures

Main output:

- Communications Management Plan

  This plan outlines:

  - What information will be communicated
  - Who will receive it
  - When and how it will be delivered
  - Who is responsible for communication activities



Manage Communications

This process focuses on creating, collecting, distributing, and storing project information according to the communication management plan.

Main activities:

- Sharing project updates and reports
- Conducting meetings and presentations
- Managing stakeholder communication
- Ensuring timely and accurate information flow

Typical outputs:

- Project communications
- Status reports
- Meeting minutes
- Performance reports

The objective is to ensure stakeholders receive relevant information in a clear and timely manner.



Monitor Communications

This process ensures that communication activities are effective and that stakeholder information needs continue to be met throughout the project.

Main activities:

- Monitoring communication effectiveness
- Gathering stakeholder feedback
- Identifying communication issues or gaps
- Adjusting communication strategies when needed

Typical outputs:

- Communication performance information
- Change requests
- Updates to communication plans and project documents

This process helps improve communication quality and ensures continuous stakeholder engagement and alignment with project objectives.

Communication Methods

- Communication methods are the approaches used to share project information among stakeholders, project teams, and other involved parties. Selecting the appropriate communication method helps ensure that information is delivered effectively, clearly, and in a timely manner.
- Communication methods are generally categorized into three main types:


Interactive Communication


Push Communication


Pull Communication



Interactive Communication

Interactive communication involves a real-time exchange of information between two or more parties.

Characteristics:

- Immediate feedback is possible
- Encourages discussion and clarification
- Most effective for complex or sensitive information

Examples:

- Meetings
- Video conferences
- Phone calls
- Workshops
- Face-to-face discussions

Advantages:

- Reduces misunderstandings
- Supports collaboration and decision-making
- Builds stronger stakeholder relationships



Push Communication

Push communication involves sending information directly to specific recipients.

Characteristics:

- Information is distributed to intended stakeholders
- Does not guarantee that the message has been received or understood

Examples:

- Emails
- Reports
- Memos
- Letters
- Notifications

Advantages:

- Efficient for distributing standard information
- Useful for regular updates and documentation



Pull Communication

Pull communication allows stakeholders to access information whenever they need it.

Characteristics:

- Information is stored in a central location
- Stakeholders retrieve information independently

Examples:

- Intranet portals
- Shared repositories
- Knowledge management systems
- Dashboards
- Project websites

Advantages:

- Suitable for large volumes of information
- Easily accessible to multiple stakeholders
- Supports information sharing across distributed teams

Selecting the correct communication method depends on factors such as:

- Stakeholder needs and preferences
- Urgency of information
- Complexity of the message
- Project size and structure
- Communication technology availability

Effective use of communication methods improves collaboration, reduces confusion, and supports successful project execution.



Communication Models



Communication models are frameworks that describe how information is transmitted and understood between a sender and a receiver during project communication.



These models help project managers understand the communication process and identify possible barriers that may affect effective information exchange.

A basic communication model typically includes the following components:

- **Sender** – The person or group initiating the message
- **Message** – The information being communicated
- **Encoding** – Converting ideas into understandable language or symbols
- **Channel/Medium** – The method used to transmit the message (email, meeting, phone call, etc.)
- **Receiver** – The person or group receiving the message
- **Decoding** – Interpreting and understanding the message
- **Feedback** – The receiver's response confirming understanding or requesting clarification

Communication models emphasize that communication is a **two-way process**, not just the delivery of information.

Common communication barriers include:

- Noise or distractions
- Language differences
- Cultural differences
- Misinterpretation of messages
- Poor communication channels
- Lack of feedback



Effective communication models help project managers:

- Improve clarity and understanding
- Reduce misunderstandings and conflicts
- Enhance stakeholder engagement
- Support accurate and timely decision-making



Understanding communication models is important in project management because successful projects depend heavily on clear, accurate, and effective communication among stakeholders and project teams.

The 5 Cs of Effective Communication

- The **5 Cs of Effective Communication** are principles that help ensure project communication is clear, meaningful, and easily understood by stakeholders and project teams. Applying these principles improves communication quality, reduces misunderstandings, and supports effective project coordination.
- The 5 Cs include:



Clear: Communication should be simple, direct, and easy to understand.



Concise: Messages should be brief and focused without unnecessary information.



Correct: Information communicated should be accurate and free from errors.



Coherent: Communication should be logical, organized, and consistent.



Controlled: Communication should be managed appropriately to maintain confidentiality, professionalism, and relevance.



In Class Activity 2

Multiple Choice Question

Which communication method allows stakeholders to access information whenever needed from a shared location?

A. Interactive Communication
B. Push Communication
C. Pull Communication
D. Verbal Communication



Multiple Choice Question

Which of the following is NOT one of the 5 Cs of effective communication?

A. Clear
B. Concise
C. Controlled
D. Complex



Short Answer Question

Briefly explain the importance of communication management in projects.



Practical Application Case Study

Scenario: Development of a Learning Management System (LMS) for Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT)

- The Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT) plans to develop a new **Learning Management System (LMS)** to improve online education and digital learning services for students and lecturers.
- The LMS is expected to support:
  - Online lectures and virtual classrooms
  - Assignment submissions
  - Student assessments and grading
  - Course material sharing
  - Communication between lecturers and students
- The project duration is **8 months** and will be carried out by the institute's IT division together with an external software development company.

Project Stakeholders

The project involves multiple stakeholders with different levels of influence and interest.

Stakeholder	Role in the Project
CEO / Academic Management	Project Sponsor
Faculty Management	Decision-making and approvals
Lecturers	System users and requirement providers
Students	Primary end users
IT Division	Technical support and maintenance
Software Development Company	System development
Quality Assurance Team	Testing and quality control
Ministry / Higher Education Representatives	Regulatory and policy oversight

Practical Integration of Stakeholder Management

Step 1: Identify Stakeholders

The project team first identifies all individuals and groups affected by the LMS implementation.

Example Stakeholders

- Academic management
- Lecturers and instructors
- Undergraduate students
- IT support staff
- External software vendor
- Higher education authorities

Importance

- If important stakeholders are missed during this stage, the project may face:
- Resistance to system adoption
- Requirement misunderstandings
- Delays and communication issues

Practical Integration of Stakeholder Management

Step 2: Stakeholder Analysis Using the Power–Interest Grid

The project team classifies stakeholders according to their level of power and interest.

Stakeholder	Power	Interest	Management Strategy
Academic Management	High	High	Manage Closely
Faculty Heads	High	Medium	Keep Satisfied
Lecturers	Medium	High	Keep Informed
Students	Low	High	Keep Informed
IT Division	Medium	High	Manage Closely
Higher Education Authorities	High	Low	Keep Satisfied

Practical Integration of Stakeholder Management

Step 3: Stakeholder Engagement Strategies

Different engagement approaches are planned for different stakeholder groups.

Stakeholder	Engagement Strategy
Academic Management	Monthly project review meetings
Lecturers	Requirement gathering workshops
Students	Feedback surveys and pilot testing
IT Division	Weekly technical meetings
Software Vendor	Sprint review meetings

Example:

Lecturers are highly interested because they use the LMS daily. Therefore, workshops and demonstrations are organized regularly to gather feedback.

Practical Integration of Communication Management

Step 4: Identify Communication Requirements

The project manager determines:

- What information should be communicated
- Who should receive it
- How often communication should occur
- Which communication method should be used



Practical Integration of Communication Management

Step 5: Develop a Communication Plan

Example Communication Plan

Information	Audience	Method	Frequency	Sender
Project Progress Report	Academic Management	Email Report	Weekly	Project Manager
Sprint Updates	Development Team	Daily Stand-up Meeting	Daily	Scrum Master
LMS Demonstration	Lecturers & Students	Online Session	Monthly	Development Team
Technical Issues	IT Division	Issue Tracking System	As Needed	QA Team

Application of Communication Methods



Interactive Communication

Used for:

- Requirement gathering meetings
- Sprint planning sessions
- Stakeholder review discussions

Examples

- Zoom meetings with lecturers
- Face-to-face project review meetings



Push Communication

Used for:

- Email updates
- Progress reports
- Official notices

Example

- Weekly email reports sent to academic management.



Pull Communication

Used for:

- Shared project documentation
- LMS user manuals
- Project dashboards

Example

- Project documents stored in a shared SLIIT portal accessible to authorized stakeholders.

Application of Communication Models

Example Situation

- A lecturer misunderstands a feature requirement because instructions were communicated only through email.

Analysis

- The message was not clearly encoded
- No immediate feedback was available
- The receiver interpreted the requirement differently

Lesson Learned

- Complex technical discussions should use interactive communication methods such as meetings or demonstrations.

Applying the 5 Cs of Communication

Principle	Example in the LMS Project
Clear	Use simple language when communicating with non-technical staff
Concise	Keep project status reports short and focused
Correct	Provide accurate project timelines and budget details
Coherent	Organize meeting minutes logically
Controlled	Share confidential project information only with authorized stakeholders





In Class Activity 3

Multiple Choice Question

A project manager identifies a stakeholder who has high influence over project decisions but shows very little interest in day-to-day project activities. What is the MOST appropriate stakeholder management strategy?

A. Manage Closely
B. Monitor Only
C. Keep Satisfied
D. Keep Informed



Multiple Choice Question

During a software development project, the project team notices that important technical requirements are frequently misunderstood when communicated through emails.
Which communication method would BEST improve understanding?

A. Pull Communication through a shared repository
B. Push Communication using weekly reports
C. Interactive Communication through workshops and meetings
D. Automated notification messages



Short Answer Question

A university is implementing a new online examination system. Students are highly supportive of the system, but lecturers are resistant because they fear technical difficulties during exams.

Identify:

1. The stakeholder engagement levels of students and lecturers.
2. One suitable communication or engagement strategy the project manager can use to reduce lecturer resistance.



Summary

- Stakeholder management helps identify and engage project stakeholders effectively.
- **Key processes:** Identify Stakeholders, Plan Engagement, Manage Engagement, Monitor Engagement
- Stakeholder analysis models help prioritize stakeholders based on power, interest, and influence.
- Communication management ensures effective information sharing among stakeholders.
- **Key communication processes:** Plan Communications, Manage Communications, Monitor Communications
- Communication methods include Interactive, Push, and Pull communication
- Effective communication follows the 5 Cs: Clear, Concise, Correct, Coherent, Controlled
- Effective stakeholder engagement and communication are critical for project success.